

# Chicago Tribune



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## Plan to end airport chaos emerges

Senate bill would pay TSA agents but omit ICE from DHS funds

By Lisa Mascaro  
and Joey Cappelletti  
ASSOCIATED PRESS

WASHINGTON — Travel disruptions deepened Tuesday as senators raced to clinch an emerging proposal to end the Department of Homeland Security shutdown by funding much of the department, including airport workers going without pay, but excluding immi-

gration enforcement and deportation operations that have been core to the dispute.

The sudden sense of urgency comes as U.S. airports are snarled by long security lines, with travelers being told to arrive hours before their flights in Atlanta, Houston and Baltimore/Washington International.

Routine Department of Homeland Security funding was halted in

mid-February ahead of the spring travel season. Nearly 11% of Transportation Security Administration workers who were scheduled to report for duty Monday — more than 3,200 — missed work, and at least 458 have quit since the shutdown began, according to DHS.

Democrats are refusing to fund the department without restraints on Trump's immigration and deportation agenda after agents killed two

citizens in Minneapolis.

A potential breakthrough came after a group of Republican senators met at the White House with President Donald Trump late Monday, after he upended talks and deployed federal immigration officers at some airport security checkpoints.

"The time to end this is now," said Senate Majority Leader John Thune, R-S.D., signaling voting ahead.

Democrats were more cautious as they scrutinized the deal, but Senate Democratic Leader Chuck

Schumer said that after Trump's "temper tantrum" eased, it appears "things are getting back on track."

But Trump was noncommittal: "I think any deal they make, I'm pretty much not happy with it."

Airport conditions have become increasingly unpredictable with swelling crowds seen in major hubs. Travelers headed to LaGuardia and John F. Kennedy airports in New York — as well as Newark Liberty International in neighboring New

See **PLAN** on Page A10



June Dreyer walks her dog, Charlie, on the pier near a memorial for slain Loyola student Sheridan Gorman at Tobey Prinz Beach in Chicago on Monday. **TERRENCE ANTONIO JAMES/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

## Pritzker: 'Real failures' in immigration led to killing

Governor says fixes need to be made to federal system after Loyola student's death

By Jeremy Gornor  
and Alice Yin  
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

SPRINGFIELD — Gov. JB Pritzker on Tuesday said there were "real failures" in the nation's immigration system that led to the fatal shooting of Loyola University student Sheridan Gorman last week, and added that while fixes need to be made to the system, that responsibility lies with the administration of President Donald Trump.

Gorman, 18, was fatally shot during the early-morning hours

of March 19 while with her friends on the lakefront near Tobey Prinz Beach Park in Chicago's Rogers Park community, prosecutors said. Charged in the killing is 25-year-old José Medina, who federal authorities said is a Venezuelan national who was in the U.S. without legal permission.

"This has been a terrible tragedy, and I know that the Gorman family has suffered mightily ... There have been real failures. Those failures, of course, extend beyond the borders of Illinois. That's — they're national failures, a failure to have comprehensive

immigration reform, a failure of the president to follow his own edict to go after the worst of the worst," Pritzker said at an unrelated event, referencing that the Trump administration stepped up immigration enforcement efforts last year in Chicago and other cities where he vowed to seek deportations of noncitizens with criminal records who are in the country illegally.

The Democratic governor's comments come as Republicans locally and nationally have blamed Gorman's killing on Pritzker and other Democrats for supporting

sanctuary policies that prevent local law enforcement from working with federal officials on immigration matters. But the governor has sought to push that blame back onto the federal government, including both Democratic President Joe Biden's administration and Trump's.

"And in my view, we have a lot of work that we need to continue to do," Pritzker continued. "But it is the job of the federal government to go after immigration enforcement, and it is the job of our

See **GORMAN** on Page A6

## Safety of e-scooters questioned after death

15-year-old honors student killed in apparent hit-and-run

By Hope Moses  
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Moments after she learned her 15-year-old niece, Violet Harris, was involved in a fatal traffic accident, Terri Dean said she traveled from her home in Burnside to the scene in South Shore at 2 a.m.

Only a handful of cars passed her on the street, she recalled, as mostly silence fell over the city. Remnants of what occurred there hours earlier painted a harsh picture of her niece's final moments.

Harris, an honors student at Hyde Park Academy High School, was killed Saturday night in an apparent hit-and-run while she rode a Lime electric scooter in Chicago's South Shore neighborhood.

According to police, the car's driver also hit a 13-year-old girl, who was transferred to Comer Children's Hospital in fair condition. As of Tuesday afternoon, no additional details were available as detectives continued to investigate.

Harris' death underscores growing concerns about the risks of riding small, low-speed electric vehicles and the shortcomings of the user agreements riders have with the companies that rent them.

E-scooters, in particular, have become the transportation of choice for Illinois children under 18, and they are also the vehicles with the lowest helmet use rates among kids, according to community health researchers at Ann & Robert H. Lurie Children's Hospital of Chicago.

Illinois requires riders of these electric vehicles, specifically those that travel between 10 and 20 mph, to be at least 18. But high-speed



See **E-SCOOTERS** on Page A6

### INSIDE



TERRENCE ANTONIO JAMES/TRIBUNE

### Nostalgic flavors

Creepies in Chicago's West Loop is a French-inspired bistro with marvelous Midwestern basement vibes. **Food & Health**

### Picks to click for Sox

A look at White Sox players to watch in 2026, including new arrivals Munetaka Murakami and Luisangel Acuña. **Sports**

## Clergy, protesters of faith to rally at 'No Kings' marches

Many say their faith compels them to join rallies against Trump

By Angie Leventis Lourgos  
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

When Archdeacon Michael Choquette joins fellow demonstrators at the upcoming "No Kings" protest in Grant Park this weekend, he intends to wear a clerical collar to send a message that "Christ is in the world."

"And as a church, we should be out there too," said Choquette of the Episcopal Diocese of Chicago. "I see it as standing in solidarity with our brothers and sisters who find themselves living in fear and living in uncertainty."

A diverse array of religious leaders and clergy from across

the Chicago area plan to take part in the return of "No Kings" protests — what has become an iconic collection of marches and demonstrations against the Trump administration held locally as well as around the globe.

They say their faith compels them to do so.

"As United Methodists, we believe that our faithful witness is fundamentally public," said the Rev. Abby Holcombe of Urban Village Church-West and River Forest United Methodist Church. "We advocate for compassion, justice and peace."

The pastor, who plans to attend a "No Kings" event in west suburban Oak Park, added that the federal government "terrorizes our neighbors, has committed

See **CLERGY** on Page A4



Terese Jackway, left, of Naperville, Lynne Sherman, of Lisle, and Lisa Yost, of Naperville, make signs during a "No Kings" protest sign-making event at Our Saviour's Lutheran Church in Naperville on March 16. **JOSH BOLAND/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

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### WEATHER FORECAST

**TODAY** H: 69 L: 52  
**THU.** H: 70 L: 30  
**FRI.** H: 43 L: 28  
Complete details on Page A14

### INDEX

Almanac ..... A10  
Arts & Living ..... B8  
Comics ..... B12-B13  
Crossword ..... B13  
Editorials ..... A7  
Horoscope ..... B12  
Nation & World ..... B4  
Obituaries ..... A10  
Television ..... B11

178th year No. 84  
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